

Business

1. TSMC — the Taiwanese company that makes chips for Apple, Nvidia, and almost everyone else — just reported its latest quarterly results. How much did its net profit grow compared to the same quarter last year?
 - a. Up 38%
 - b. Up 77%
 - c. Up 120%
2. China's birth rate has been falling for years, and the education sector is now feeling the pain. Roughly how many kindergartens and primary schools did China close in 2025 alone?
 - a. Around 5,000
 - b. Around 15,000
 - c. Around 30,000
3. Delivery Hero, the German food delivery company behind brands including Foodpanda, recently backed a takeover bid from a major US tech company. Who is buying it, and for how much?
 - a. Uber, for €13 billion
 - b. Amazon, for €9 billion
 - c. DoorDash, for €11 billion
4. At a recent auction, a T. rex skeleton became the most expensive dinosaur fossil ever sold. What did the winning bidder pay?
 - a. \$28 million
 - b. \$50 million
 - c. \$50 million, paid in cryptocurrency

Economics

5. US inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) fell to 3.5% in June, its sharpest monthly drop since 2020. One unusual factor helped bring it down. What was it?
 - a. A temporary ceasefire between the US and Iran, which pushed energy prices lower
 - b. A sharp fall in food prices after a bumper harvest in the Midwest
 - c. The Federal Reserve cut interest rates unexpectedly, cooling demand

6. The Trump administration recently announced a 25% tariff (a tax on imported goods) on most imports from Brazil. Which of these is NOT a risk that economists would typically associate with tariffs of this kind?
 - a. Higher prices for US consumers who buy Brazilian goods
 - b. Retaliation from Brazil, hitting US exporters
 - c. A sudden fall in US unemployment as domestic factories immediately hire
7. The UK government recently nationalised British Steel, taking it back into public ownership. China's government publicly objected. Why does Beijing have standing to complain?
 - a. British Steel was previously owned by Chinese company Jingye Group
 - b. China supplies most of the raw iron ore used in the plant
 - c. A Chinese state bank had just approved a rescue loan for the steelmaker
8. The 'great wealth transfer' refers to the trillions of dollars baby boomers are expected to pass on to younger generations in the coming decades. Two recent studies tried to put a number on it. What was the range of their estimates?
 - a. Between \$5 trillion and \$15 trillion
 - b. Between \$36 trillion and over \$100 trillion
 - c. Between \$20 trillion and \$50 trillion

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Australia
 - c. China
10. Which economist, writing in the 1800s, first described the idea that free trade between nations benefits both sides — even if one country is better at producing everything?
 - a. Adam Smith
 - b. David Ricardo
 - c. John Stuart Mill

Business

1. TSMC — the Taiwanese company that makes chips for Apple, Nvidia, and almost everyone else — just reported its latest quarterly results. How much did its net profit grow compared to the same quarter last year?

b. TSMC's net profit rose 77% year-on-year, beating Wall Street expectations. The surge reflects booming demand for advanced chips powering AI systems. TSMC also pledged \$100 billion to expand manufacturing capacity inside the US — a sign of how central chipmaking has become to geopolitical strategy.

2. China's birth rate has been falling for years, and the education sector is now feeling the pain. Roughly how many kindergartens and primary schools did China close in 2025 alone?

c. China shuttered nearly 30,000 kindergartens and primary schools in a single year. Fewer children being born means fewer pupils — and schools cannot fill their classrooms. China's total fertility rate (average births per woman) is now around 1.0, well below the 2.1 needed to keep the population stable.

3. Delivery Hero, the German food delivery company behind brands including Foodpanda, recently backed a takeover bid from a major US tech company. Who is buying it, and for how much?

a. Uber is acquiring Delivery Hero in a €13 billion deal, with Delivery Hero's board backing the offer. For Uber, it is a major expansion of its food delivery arm, Uber Eats, across Europe, Asia, and the Middle East. Delivery Hero had been struggling under heavy debt, making a strategic exit attractive for its leadership.

4. At a recent auction, a T. rex skeleton became the most expensive dinosaur fossil ever sold. What did the winning bidder pay?

b. The T. rex sold for \$50 million, smashing the previous record of \$44.6 million set when hedge fund billionaire Ken Griffin bought a stegosaurus in 2024. Dinosaur fossils have quietly become a serious asset class among ultra-wealthy collectors — which raises genuinely awkward questions for palaeontologists who would rather they sat in museums.

Economics

5. US inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) fell to 3.5% in June, its sharpest monthly drop since 2020. One unusual factor helped bring it down. What was it?

a. A brief ceasefire in the US-Iran conflict helped push energy prices down, dragging the Consumer Price Index (the standard measure of inflation, tracking the cost of a typical basket of goods) lower. Energy prices are volatile and can swing inflation quickly — which is why economists often look at 'core' inflation, which strips out food and energy, for a cleaner read.

6. The Trump administration recently announced a 25% tariff (a tax on imported goods) on most imports from Brazil. Which of these is NOT a risk that economists would typically associate with tariffs of this kind?

c. A sudden jump in employment is not a typical near-term risk — it is the hoped-for upside, and even that tends to materialise slowly and unevenly. The genuine short-term risks are higher prices for consumers and retaliatory tariffs from Brazil on American exports. Brazil is a major supplier of goods including coffee, steel, and agricultural products to the US.

7. The UK government recently nationalised British Steel, taking it back into public ownership. China's government publicly objected. Why does Beijing have standing to complain?

a. British Steel was owned by Jingye Group, a Chinese company, before the UK government stepped in. Beijing called the nationalisation unfair interference with a foreign investor's assets. For the UK, the move was about protecting domestic steelmaking capacity — the Scunthorpe plant is one of the last places in Britain still making steel from raw materials.

8. The 'great wealth transfer' refers to the trillions of dollars baby boomers are expected to pass on to younger generations in the coming decades. Two recent studies tried to put a number on it. What was the range of their estimates?

b. The two studies produced estimates ranging from \$36 trillion to over \$100 trillion — a gap so large it tells you almost as much about methodological uncertainty as it does about inherited wealth. Either figure would dwarf most national economies. The transfer is expected to reshape wealth inequality, asset markets, and the financial advice industry over the next two decades.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer, accounting for roughly half of global mine output. Chile holds the largest known reserves — most of it sitting in the Atacama salt flats — but Australia extracts more. China, despite mining relatively little lithium itself, dominates the processing of it, giving it enormous power over the global battery supply chain.

10. Which economist, writing in the 1800s, first described the idea that free trade between nations benefits both sides — even if one country is better at producing everything?

b. David Ricardo developed the theory of comparative advantage in 1817, showing that countries benefit from specialising in what they produce most efficiently relative to other goods, then trading — even if a rival nation is more productive overall. It remains one of the most influential and counterintuitive ideas in economics, and is still the intellectual backbone of the case for free trade.